

8. The **epicentre** is the point on the Earth's surface directly above an earthquake. Seismic stations detect earthquakes by the tracings made on seismographs.

(a) Surface, P and S waves are three types of earthquake waves.
Tick (✓) the boxes next to the **three** correct statements about earthquake waves. [3]

Surface waves travel the fastest ☐

S waves travel on the surface of the Earth ☐

S waves are transverse waves ☐

P waves travel through solids and liquids ☐

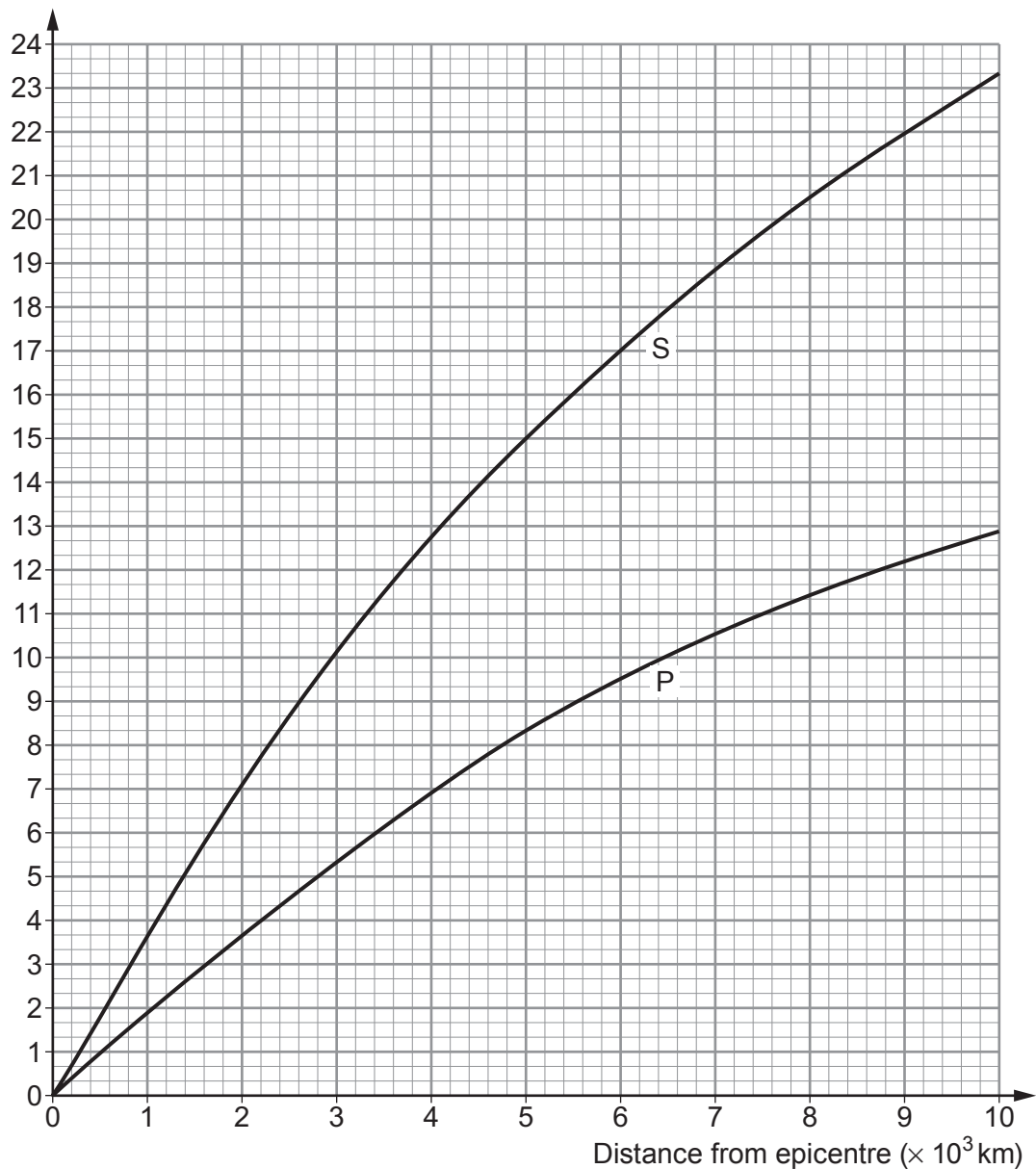
P waves are longitudinal waves ☐

S waves cause the most damage ☐



- (b) The graph shows the time taken by P and S waves to travel different distances from the epicentre.

Time (min)



Each small square on the time axis represents 20 s.

- (i) Use the graph to answer the following questions.

I. State the time it takes for a P wave to travel 5×10^3 km from the epicentre.

[1]

time = min s

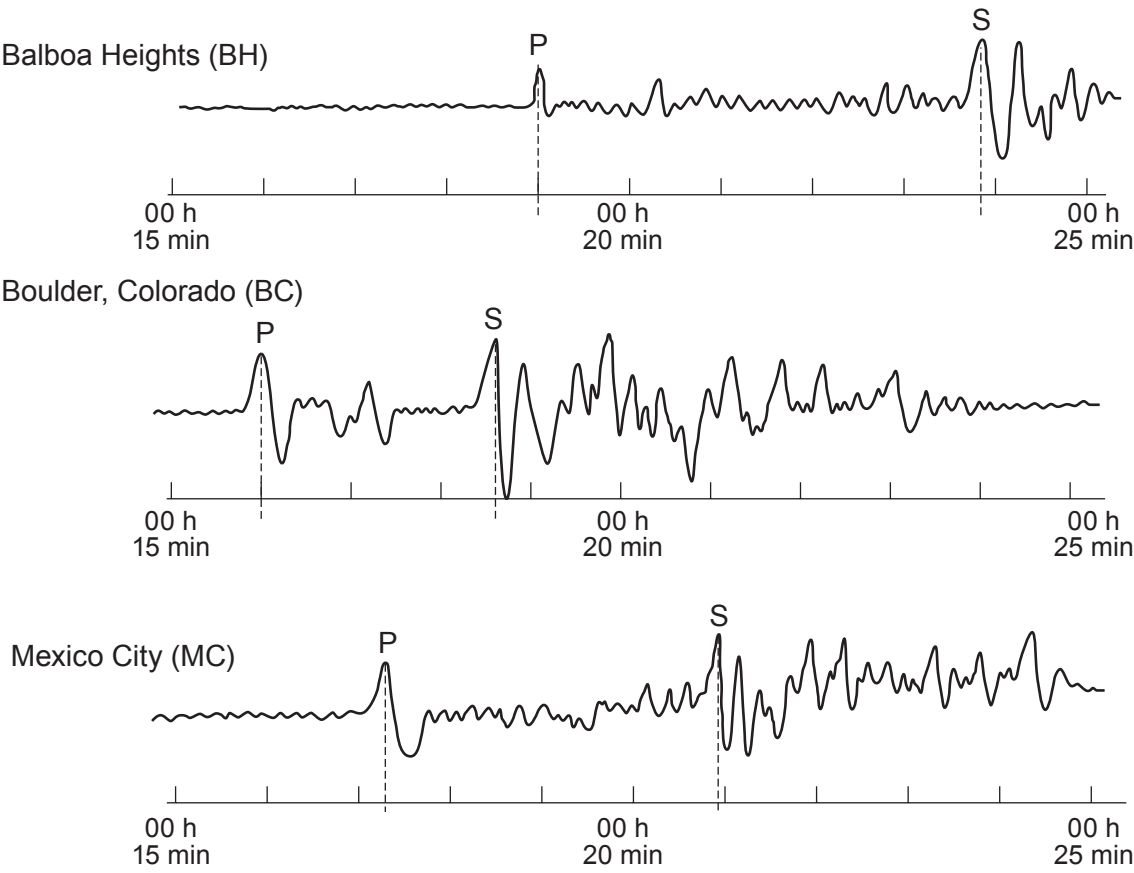
II. State the **extra** time it takes S waves to travel 5×10^3 km from the epicentre.

[1]

time = min s



(ii) Study the three seismograph tracings below. Tracings made at three separate seismic stations are needed to locate an earthquake epicentre. P shows the arrival of P waves and S shows the arrival of S waves.



Use the information in the graph and tracings to **complete the table**. [3]

City	Arrival time of P waves (h:min:s)	Arrival time of S waves (h:min:s)	Time difference for P and S waves (h:min:s)	Distance to epicentre ($\times 10^3$ km)
Balboa Heights (BH)	00:19:00	00:23:50	00:04:50	3.2
Boulder, Colorado (BC)	 : :	00:18:40	 : :	
Mexico City (MC)	00:17:15	00:20:55	00:03:40	2.2

TURN OVER FOR THE REST OF THE QUESTION



- (iii) The P waves arriving at Balboa Heights (BH) took 6 **minutes** to travel from the epicentre. Use an equation from page 2 to calculate the speed of the P waves arriving at Balboa Heights in **km/s**. [Note that $3.2 \times 10^3 \text{ km} = 3\,200 \text{ km}$] [2]

Speed = km/s

- (iv) The data is used to locate the epicentre of the earthquake. **Indicate with crosses (X) on the diagram opposite two** possible positions for the location of the earthquake. [1]

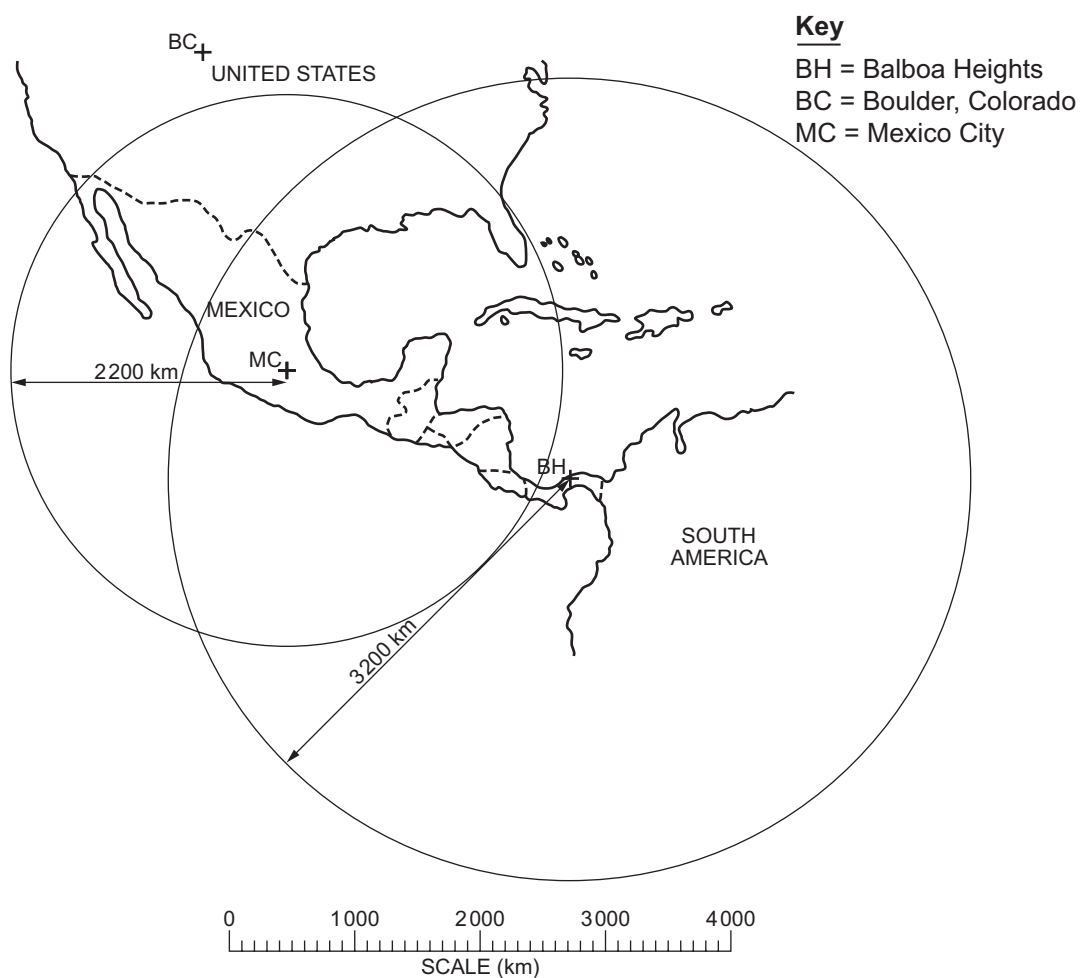
- (v) Use the data for Boulder Colorado (BC) to show clearly **on the diagram opposite** the actual location of the epicentre. Justify how you have arrived at your answer. [2]

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END OF PAPER

